

TV SHOW

His Dark Materials Season 2

★★★★☆ | It seems that fantasy shows have recently made a massive comeback in terms of actual visibility and influence. Just in the past few years, we've got shows such as *The Dark Crystal* on Netflix, *Carnival Row* on Amazon Prime Video and just last year we got the excellent adaptation of *His Dark Materials* on HBO. Even though the show was a little plot-heavy and required you to keep track of all these characters and side plots, the result was one of the most engaging and visually spectacular fantasy shows on TV. We can safely say that season 2 of *His Dark Mate-*



rials trumps the first in almost every way. The second season begins right where the first left off. Lord Asriel has now opened up an interdimensional rift and stepped through it and our intrepid hero Lyra has now followed her

father into the unknown. The second season truly begins with a bang and does not suffer from the excessive world-building of the first season. The plot is already in motion, we know who everyone is and now it's time for war.

Based on the second book by Philip Pullman, *The Subtle Knife*, the second season of *His Dark Materials* is essentially the middle chapter of the trilogy and feels like it as well. The tone is not as dark and dreary as the first as this season seems to be a little more hopeful than the last in its themes.

Another plus point to the show is its art design. The city of Cittagazze is stunning and will keep fantasy nerds up at night thinking about the possibilities.

We definitely suggest checking out the entire first season before jumping into the second as the world is deep and requires you pay attention every step of the way. If you're at all into fantasy and magic and all that good stuff, you'll have a grand time with *His Dark Materials* Season 2.

MOVIE

Tenet

★★★★☆ | I watched this movie in theatres in Australia in October, twice! In India, some of you will watch this movie as soon as theatres reopen, and don't care what this review or any review says, because honestly you are just dying to get back to overpaying for pop-corn again in movie theatres.

Everyone else possibly just wants to know if watching this movie in a theatre is worth the risk of catching COVID-19. And the answer to that is... it depends.

If sci-fi is a genre you like, and you liked *Memento*, *Inception* and *Interstellar*, then this is definitely a movie that you will absolutely love. Just be forewarned that you might want (or even need) to watch it a second or maybe even a third time in order to understand it, and therefore, fall in



love with it. There is so much detail you will miss in the first watch, as you strain your brain to make sense of what you're seeing on the screen. I'm pretty sure I missed a lot of detail even the second time I watched it!

For those of you who want more details than this, but are worried

about spoilers, don't be. If I'm being honest, I could potentially tell you the whole plot of the movie and you'd be even more confused than you will be after the first time you watch the film. We're obviously going to love the Indian connection of Dimple Kapadia and the scenes shot in very familiar places in Mumbai. There are just six actors in the movie (not counting the extras), even though it actually feels like a lot more.

Production quality is exactly what you'd expect from a major Hollywood movie, and there are some interesting things done with sound that are pretty awesome.

My only complaint (and the reason this movie is not scored 5/5) is that it feels like Nolan was more interested in pushing the boundaries of filmmaking and complexity rather than leading his audience to a true a-ha moment at the end like he did with *Inception*. I dare say people might even hate the movie after the first watch, but rate it higher with every subsequent rewatch.